Loupe

Install and quick start

Loupe is a screen capture tool for the Mac. It takes screenshots of a region, a window or the whole screen, lets you annotate them (arrows, text, numbered steps, blur), records video, reads text off the screen, and turns a series of clicks into a step-by-step guide.

> **Private by design.** Everything happens on your own Mac: captures are saved in your Pictures folder, text recognition runs locally, and nothing is uploaded. Loupe only goes online to ask GitHub whether there is a newer version, and it verifies that download before installing it.

1. Install

> **Before you start: become a local administrator.** Open the **PaymentIQ Self Service** app and request **Administrator Mode**. You need it to put Loupe in Applications and to run the Terminal line in step 3. Do the same before each update.

1. Download `Loupe-<version>-universal.dmg` from the Releases page: **github.com/nicklasklasson/loupe/releases**. It runs on Apple Silicon and Intel Macs.
2. Open the dmg and drag Loupe onto Applications. If an older Loupe is there, choose **Replace**. Eject the Loupe disk afterwards.
3. Open Loupe from Applications. macOS will most likely say "*Apple could not verify 'Loupe' is free of malware that may harm your Mac or compromise your privacy*", with the buttons **Done** and **Move to Bin**. Click **Done**, never Move to Bin. Then open Terminal and run this line:

   ```
   xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Loupe.app
   ```

   Open Loupe again and it starts normally. If Terminal says "Operation not permitted", Administrator Mode isn't active yet. If the warning comes back even so, run `xattr -cr /Applications/Loupe.app` instead.

   Why this is needed: Loupe isn't registered with Apple (that takes a paid developer account), so macOS warns about every app downloaded from the internet that isn't. The line only removes the "downloaded from the internet" mark; it doesn't change Loupe. You can also try System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Open Anyway**, but on company Macs that button often doesn't appear.
4. Loupe shows its home window and puts a small magnifying glass in the menu bar. Closing the window keeps Loupe running there, so the shortcuts keep working; to quit, use **Quit Loupe** in the menu bar icon's menu.
5. Take your first capture with ⌥ ⇧ 1. macOS asks for **Screen Recording** permission: switch Loupe on under System Settings › Privacy & Security › Screen Recording (called *Screen & System Audio Recording* on newer macOS), then quit Loupe and open it again. Step capture (section 6) needs **Accessibility** in the same way.

> **Coming from Loupe 0.2.x?** After step 3, open Screen Recording in System Settings, select the old Loupe entry, remove it with the **−** button, and allow Loupe again when it asks. The setting looks switched on already, but that entry belongs to the old build. Same for Accessibility if you use step capture. This is a one-time thing: from now on new versions arrive through **Check for Updates…** and keep your permissions.

2. Capturing

WHAT	SHORTCUT	HOW IT WORKS
Region	⌥ ⇧ 1	The screen freezes and dims. Drag to select an area; a magnifier shows the pixels under the cursor. A single click or Enter captures the whole screen, Esc cancels.
Window	⌥ ⇧ 2	Pick any open window from a gallery.
Full screen	⌥ ⇧ 3	The screen under your cursor.
Record video	⌥ ⇧ R	A screen, window or area, with optional microphone and camera bubble. See section 5.
Copy text	⌥ ⇧ T	Drag over text on screen; Loupe reads it and copies it. See section 5.
Step capture	⌥ ⇧ S	Every click becomes a numbered screenshot. See section 6.

Every capture is **saved to your library** (Pictures › Loupe, or the folder you choose with **Change folder…**), **copied to your clipboard** and **opened in the editor**, all at once. So you can paste it straight into Slack without touching the editor, and the editor window is free to close whenever you like (section 4).

Timer. Each action in the home window has a **Timer** switch (also under **Timer** in the menu bar menu). With it on, Loupe waits 3, 5 or 10 seconds before capturing, so you can open a menu or hover over something first. Esc cancels a countdown.

The home window also has **Open image…** and **Paste image**, which opens the image on your clipboard in the editor. If a shortcut shows crossed out in the home window, another app has taken it.

3. The editor

Pick a tool from the left rail or with its key, draw on the capture, and style the selection from the top bar. Annotations may go past the edge of the screenshot; the canvas grows to fit them.

KEY	TOOL	NOTES
V	Select	Click an annotation to move it, drag its handles to resize it. Arrow keys nudge, Delete removes.
A L	Arrow, Line	Hold ⇧ to snap to 45°.
R E	Rectangle, Ellipse	Outline or filled. Hold ⇧ for a square or circle.
T	Text	Plain text with a legibility halo, or filled callout labels. Double-click to edit; ⌘ Enter or Esc to finish.
S	Numbered steps	They count up by themselves; you can set the next number.
H	Highlighter	
B	Blur	Pixelates what's under the box: emails, card numbers, names. Use it before sharing anything with customer data.
C	Crop	Drag over the part to keep, then Enter.

SHORTCUT	DOES
⌘ C	**Copy** the annotated image to the clipboard. The window then closes (section 4).
⌘ S	**Save** over the capture in the library. For an image opened from outside the library, Save makes a copy instead.
⌘ ⇧ S	**Save as** a PNG or JPEG anywhere.
⌘ W	**Close** the window. Works for every Loupe window.
⌘ ⌫	**Discard**: move the capture to the Bin and close, no questions asked. For an image opened from outside the library it only closes the window.
⌘ Z / ⌘ ⇧ Z	Undo / redo.
⌘ 0 / ⌘ 1	Zoom to fit / 100 %. ⌘ + scroll wheel zooms, hold Space and drag to pan.

The top bar also has **Pin** (keep the capture floating above other windows), **Copy text** (read all text in the image) and **Discard**. While a capture has unsaved annotations, an **Edited** badge sits next to its name; after Save the button says **Saved** ✓ for a moment.

4. Capture windows close themselves

You'll never end the day with a screen full of old captures. Because every capture is already in the library and on the clipboard, Loupe closes editor windows for you:

- **Copy closes the window.** You copy because you're off to paste the image somewhere, so the window gets out of the way.
- **Untouched windows close on their own** after sitting in the background for 2 minutes. A window you're looking at is never closed, and the timer starts over whenever you come back to it.
- **Edited captures are never closed by the timer.** When you close one yourself, or copy from it, Loupe asks **Save / Don't Save / Keep Editing**. Save writes the annotated capture to your library; Don't Save keeps the original as it was. Save is the default, so ⌘ C then Enter copies, saves and closes.
- **Close all capture windows** in the menu bar menu closes everything at once, asking about unsaved changes along the way.

Both behaviours are settings at the bottom of the home window: **Close capture after Copy** (on/off) and **Close untouched captures after** (30 seconds, 2 minutes, 10 minutes or never). Next to them is **Show Loupe in the Dock**: switch it off and Loupe lives in the menu bar only, like a utility; the magnifying glass menu has everything and ⌘ W still closes windows.

5. Pins, text from the screen, and video

Pin

Pin in the editor or on a library tile keeps a capture floating above every other window, handy when you're comparing two screens. Drag it to move it, scroll to zoom. Double-click or press Esc to close it; right-click for copy, copy text, opacity, actual size and **Close all pinned captures** (also in the menu bar menu).

Copy text (OCR)

Press ⌥ ⇧ T and drag over any text on screen: an error message, a transaction ID in a PDF, text in a video call. Loupe reads it, copies it to the clipboard and shows it in a small window where you can correct it and copy again. English and Swedish are built in, and recognition runs on your Mac.

Record video

Press ⌥ ⇧ R and pick a screen, a window or **Select an area…**. You can include your microphone, and tick **Show camera** for a round camera bubble on screen (macOS asks for camera access the first time). A control bar counts down 3 seconds, then shows the time with **Pause**, **Stop** and **Discard**. Recordings are saved to the library as MP4.

When you stop, the recording opens in the **video editor**. Drag on the timeline, or use I / O at the playhead, to mark a part and click **Remove this part**; you can remove several. **Save as new video** writes an *(edited)* copy next to the original.

6. Step capture: turn clicks into a guide

1. Press ⌥ ⇧ S. The first time, macOS asks for **Accessibility** permission (System Settings › Privacy & Security › Accessibility), because Loupe has to notice clicks in other apps. It listens only while a step capture runs and never records typing.
2. Work through the task. Every left click becomes a numbered screenshot of the screen just before the click, with a ring where you clicked. **Pause** stops capturing for a moment.
3. Click **Done**. The guide opens: name it, describe each step, reorder or delete steps, and click a screenshot to annotate, blur or crop it in the editor.
4. **Export PDF…** or **Export web page…** produces a document with every step, ready to send to a customer or put on Confluence. Guides are kept in the library with a "Guide" badge.

7. The library

The home window lists every capture, recording and guide in the library folder, newest first. Click one to open it; hover for **Copy** (to the clipboard, without opening it), **Pin**, **Show** (in Finder) and **Delete** (to the Bin). **Change folder…** picks where new captures go, for example a shared drive; existing files stay where they are. If that folder can't be reached, Loupe saves to Pictures › Loupe and says so.

8. Updating to a new version

Loupe updates itself. Once a day it asks GitHub whether there's a newer version; when there is, it lets you know with a notification and an **Update to Loupe …** item in the menu bar menu.

1. Request **Administrator Mode** in the PaymentIQ Self Service app.
2. Choose **Update to Loupe …** (or **Check for Updates…**) in the menu bar menu or the Loupe menu, then click **Install and restart**.

Loupe downloads the new version, checks that it's signed with the Loupe certificate, replaces itself in Applications and restarts. Your settings and captures are kept, your Screen Recording and Accessibility permissions stay granted, and there's no "could not verify" warning. You can switch the daily check off in the updates window.

Updating by hand works too: quit Loupe, download the new dmg from the Releases page, drag Loupe to Applications and choose Replace. If macOS then says it could not verify Loupe, click Done and run the Terminal line from step 3 of the installation.

9. If something doesn't work

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"Apple could not verify 'Loupe' is free of malware"	Click **Done** and run the `xattr` line from step 3 with Administrator Mode on. Make sure you open the Loupe in Applications, not the one in the dmg.
Capture fails: "Turn on Loupe in … Screen Recording" even though it's switched on	That entry belongs to an older build. Remove Loupe from the list with the **−** button, quit Loupe, open it, and allow it again.
Step capture doesn't react to clicks	Allow Loupe under Privacy & Security › **Accessibility**, then quit and reopen Loupe.
A shortcut shows crossed out in the home window	Another app uses it. Use the home window buttons or the menu bar menu instead.
"Installing needs Administrator Mode" in the updates window	Request it in the PaymentIQ Self Service app, then click **Try again**.
"Couldn't copy to the clipboard"	Use **Save as**, then drag the file into Slack.
Loupe isn't in the Dock but the magnifying glass is in the menu bar	Loupe is running; **Show Loupe in the Dock** is switched off in the home window. Click the magnifying glass and choose **Open Loupe**.

Questions, ideas and bugs: tell Nicklas on Slack.